



Keeping (AC)Count

It's that time of year again—tax season! We take a look at the top nine tax and accounting software available to help you decide which the right one for your company is

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The air is musty and carries the stench of old books. An old, balding, bespectacled man sits punching numbers at an ancient machine. People have long since forgotten his name, and know him only as 'Munshiji'. The name is always spoken in fearful awe; for Munshiji is the be-all and end-all of all things financial in the company. None dare disturb him when tax season comes rolling in...

If this sounds like the beginning of a fictional whodunit, it's

only because *Munshiji* no longer exists. He was replaced by a computer and accounting software. The air is no longer musty, and the old ledgers have been incorporated into the computer's hard disk—always available as hard copies, courtesy the printer. Today, even small companies need to implement a corporate style of process management, and accounting is one aspect they can least afford to skimp on. Luckily, professional accounting software solutions don't cost an arm and a leg. Neither do they threaten to peer into your souls through ancient

spectacles if you dare inquire about Form 16...

We take an in-depth look at the top nine tax and accounts packages available in India to help you decide which one suits your needs best.

The software—ACE 7, atACC, BUSY, Ex Personal Accountant, Expert Quick Accounting 3.0, Simply Accounting Pro, T++, Tally 6.3 and Wings EZ—are packed with tools and functions that can make cash adjustments, debit, credit and invoicing a lot easier, maybe even fun... maybe.

Early on, this test discovered that all nine had nearly identical